

The settings in *The Bridge* clearly establish realism and the film noir elements of the genre and also employ the typical Scandinavian elements of the cold weather and the dark. The vast Nordic landscape creates a sense of isolation and alienation. The iconic image of the Oresund Bridge features regularly in the series. Many of the settings create a sense of entrapment including corridors and dimly lit locations, for example the warehouse crime scene.

Technical codes

Camera shots, movement and angles work together to communicate messages and 'show' the narrative. *The Bridge* has high production values and a distinctive style which is used to convey information without the use of dialogue.

- Close-ups advance the relationships between characters and establish tension and a dynamic. This is evident in the conversation between Saga and the other characters. Often the close-ups show the profile of the character or are in silhouette, the opening introduction to Saga in the lift combines both to construct her enigmatic character.
- Tracking shots are used to introduce both Saga and Hanne, constructing both as powerful women with a job to do and are also used to involve the audience as part of the investigative process as they follow the characters.
- Establishing shots are quick ways of communicating information, the bridge is used regularly to indicate changes of setting between Sweden and Denmark and bird's eye view city shots are used similarly. These shots also serve to create a sense of cultural verisimilitude establishing a real city in which the characters function, so reinforcing their believability.
- The film noir technique of shooting through windows, or behind obstacles is used, positioning the audience as looking in on the scene or the lives of the characters as an outsider. The sense of entrapment created by this filming in some cases suggests their isolation or that they have something to hide. For example, the audience often views Saga from behind glass or another barrier and Henrik and his children are first viewed through the window.
- The post-production editing creates a desaturated colour palette which contributes to the dark, melancholic feel of the programme.

Audio codes

Sound and music are effective in communicating meaning in this programme:

- **Music:** the haunting track used for the credit sequence foreshadows the slow pace of the

programme and creates expectations of the style of programme to follow. The tense music at the start of the episode has intertextual references to the horror genre building audience expectation of the macabre scene that unfolds.

- **Diegetic sound:** the clicking of the crime scene investigator's cameras at the start establishes generic realism. The sound of the cans at Morten's cabin is both unsettling and on the second visit, an action code for the explosion to follow which is then followed by a disconcerting silence.
- **Dialogue:** some of the dialogue is conventional of a crime drama and is related to the investigation and police procedure and as such advances the narrative. Other elements of dialogue serve to develop characters and relationships. Saga's clipped, at times forced, dialogue contributes to her idiosyncratic character. She is very literal in her understanding and her responses are refreshingly honest. When the owner of the site where the victim is thought to have been murdered asks her '*Could you hurry up a bit?*', she replies '*No*'. The conversations between the detectives and Helle Anker's wife create a back story and possible motives for her murder. Saga's mother's reference to '*your crime*' in relation to Saga creates an enigma at the end of the first episode and provides some insight into Saga's past, this is particularly intriguing as Saga has stated earlier in the episode, '*I don't like my mum*'.

PART 2: STARTING POINTS – Representation

Consider how representations are constructed through a process of selection and combination.

All representations are constructed and are not 'windows on the world'. Representations are constructed through media language, the information in the previous section will therefore be relevant when exploring representation in *The Bridge*. Media products are constructed through a process of mediation to communicate meanings using elements of media language including:

- **Technical codes.** Camera shots, angles, movements and editing combine to construct representations and to position audiences in relation to those representations.
- **Audio codes:** diegetic and non-diegetic sound including a soundtrack, mood music and dialogue contribute to the construction of representations.
- **Iconography:** clothing, particularly in relation to the cultural context, contributes to the construction of representations and will have been a key consideration of the producers in creating the characters and their roles.